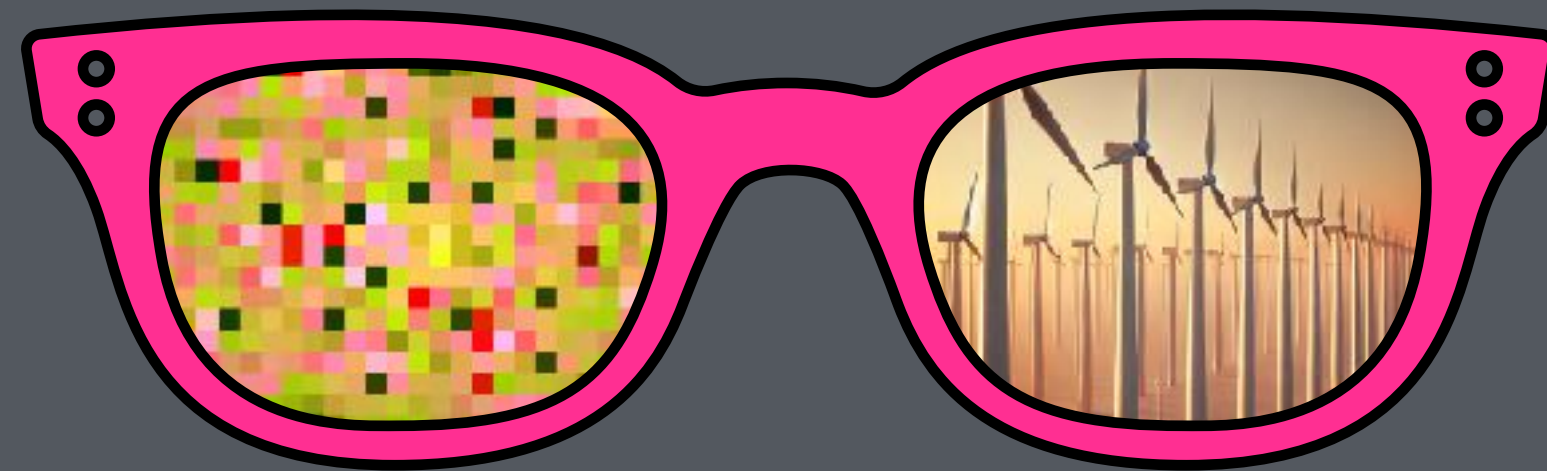


Data and the State

DATA 20195 / 30195



Living in cities, suburbs,
and neighborhoods

Lecture 16, Wednesday May 13

Data collection

1. National eviction database, 2000-2018
 - Purchased data from LexisNexis
 - Validated against court-reported aggregates

 2. Eviction Tracking System, 2020-present
 - Scraping public-facing court dockets
 - Requesting data from the courts
 - Granted access to court systems
- Lots of cleaning, geocoding, linkage work!

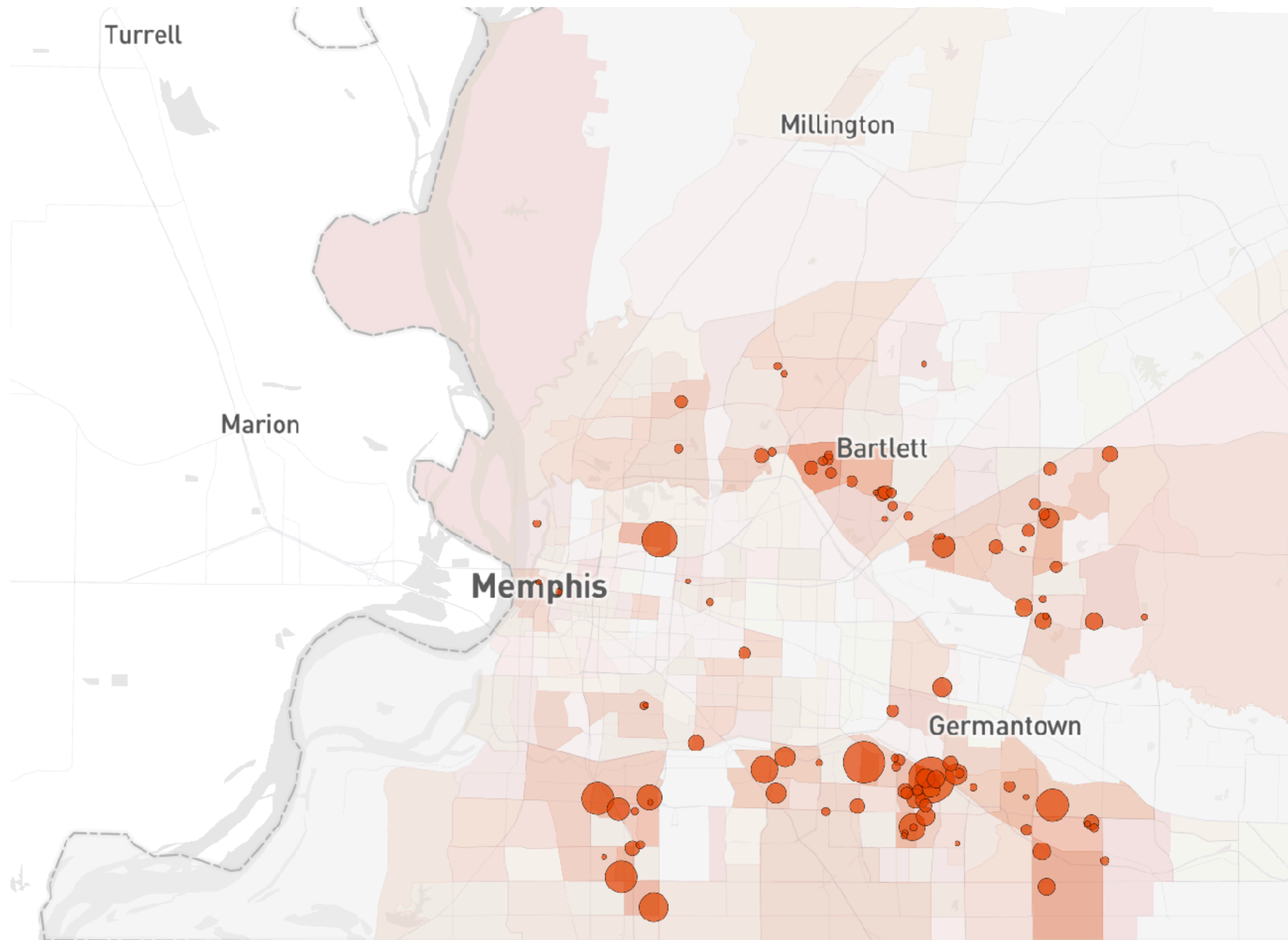
5

Eviction patterns pre-COVID

- Average of 3.6 million eviction cases every year
 - ~7% of all renter households filed against annually
 - 9% eviction filing rate in New York
- Serial eviction filings
 - Eviction as a rent collection tool
- Not just a big-city issue
 - Affects mid-size and smaller cities
 - Increasingly concentrated in suburbs
 - Risk for rural renters as well

Variation *within* cities

- Eviction cases are heavily concentrated
 - In buildings, not just neighborhoods
 - Same buildings, year after year



Who is evicted?

- 7.6 million individuals are threatened with eviction each year
- Children bear the brunt of the eviction crisis
 - 40% of those threatened with eviction are children
 - 2.9 million children filed against each year
- Seniors also face the risk of eviction
 - 170,000 renters aged 65+ face a filing annually

Graetz, N., Gershenson, C., Hepburn, P., Porter, S. R., Sandler, D. H., & Desmond, M. (2023). **A comprehensive demographic profile of the US evicted population.** PNAS, 120(41)

methods

linkage of court records to Census microdata and administrative data

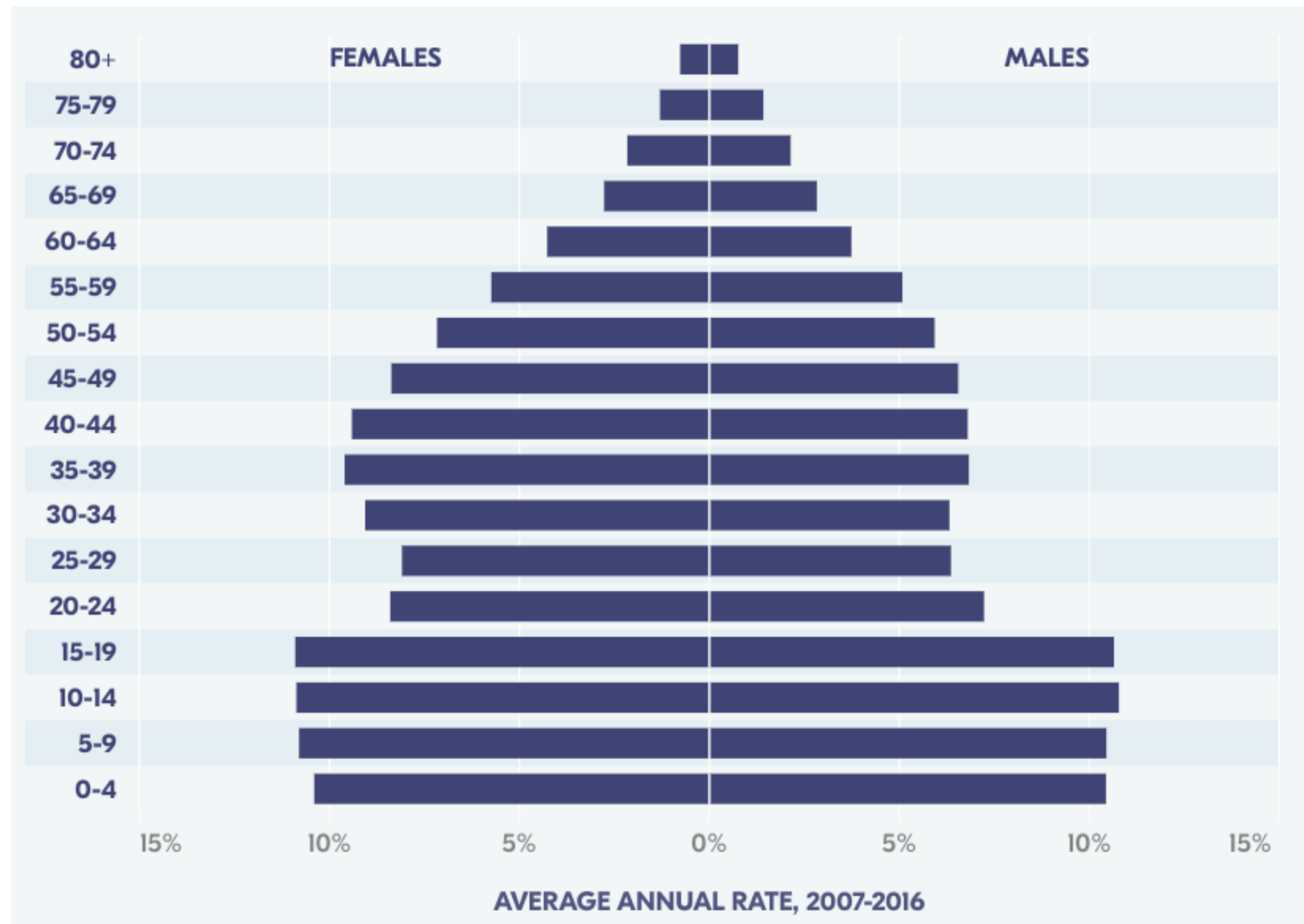
replication repo

[github.com/ngraetz/
pnas_demographics_of_eviction](https://github.com/ngraetz/pnas_demographics_of_eviction)

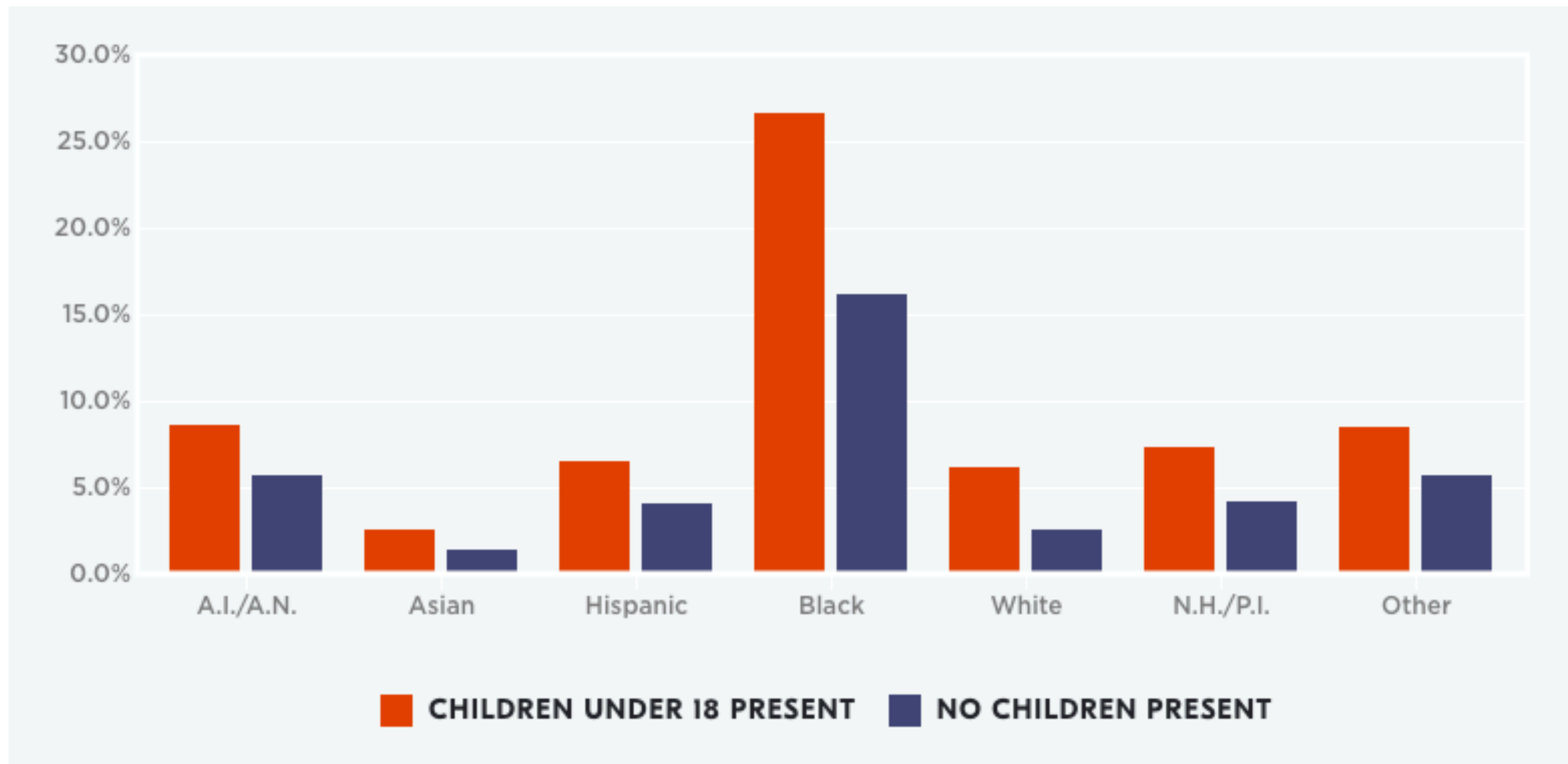
Eviction risk by age

"risk":household was filed on, as a share of people living in renter households

recall informal evictions thought to outnumber these formal filings 2:1

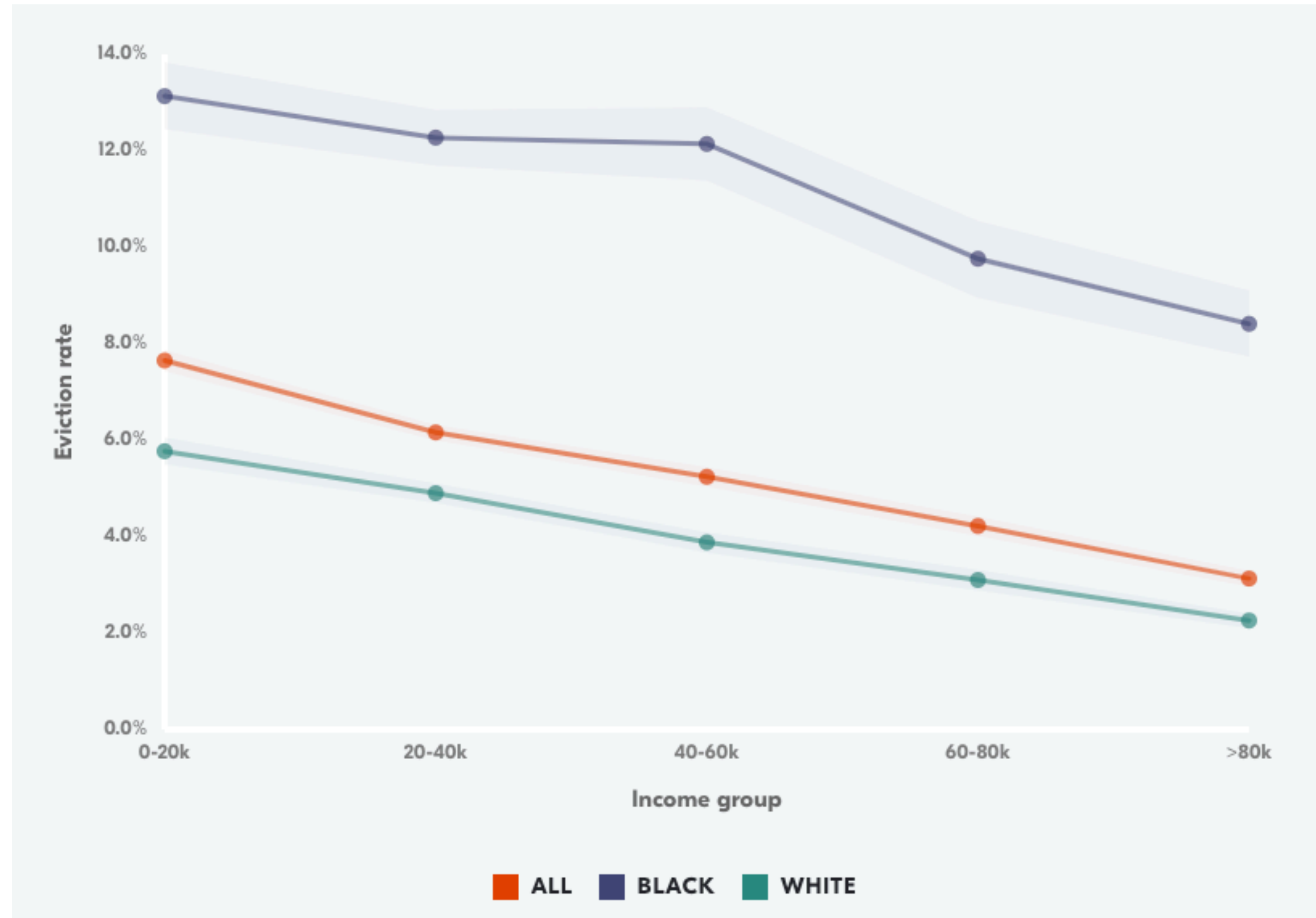


Eviction risk by race/ethnicity



(by household)	owner	renter
NH White	75%	25%
Black	44%	56%
Hispanic	49%	51%
AAPI	62%	38%
national avg	65%	35%

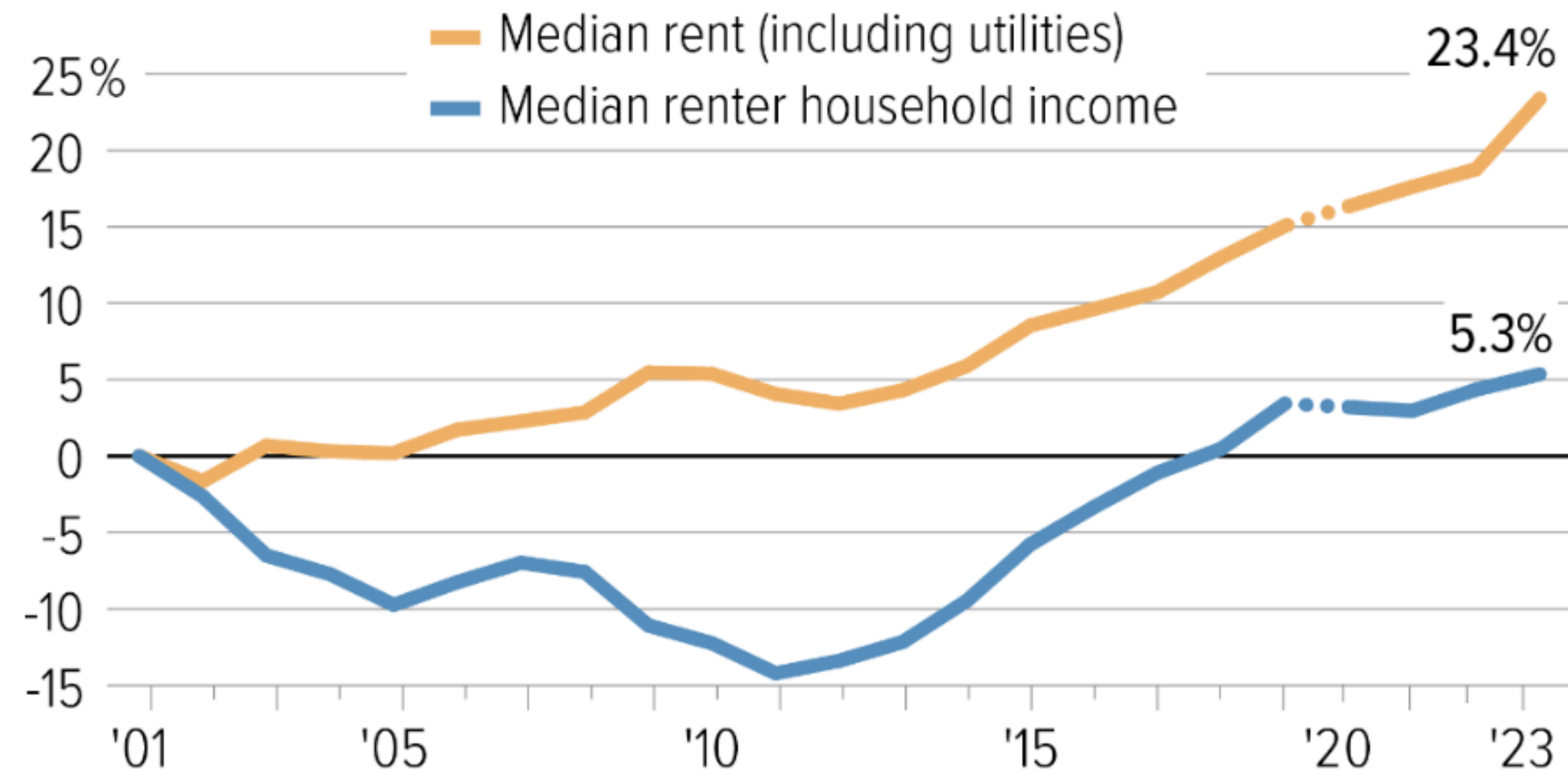
Eviction risk by income



Why is this happening?

Renters' Incomes Haven't Caught Up to Rising Housing Costs

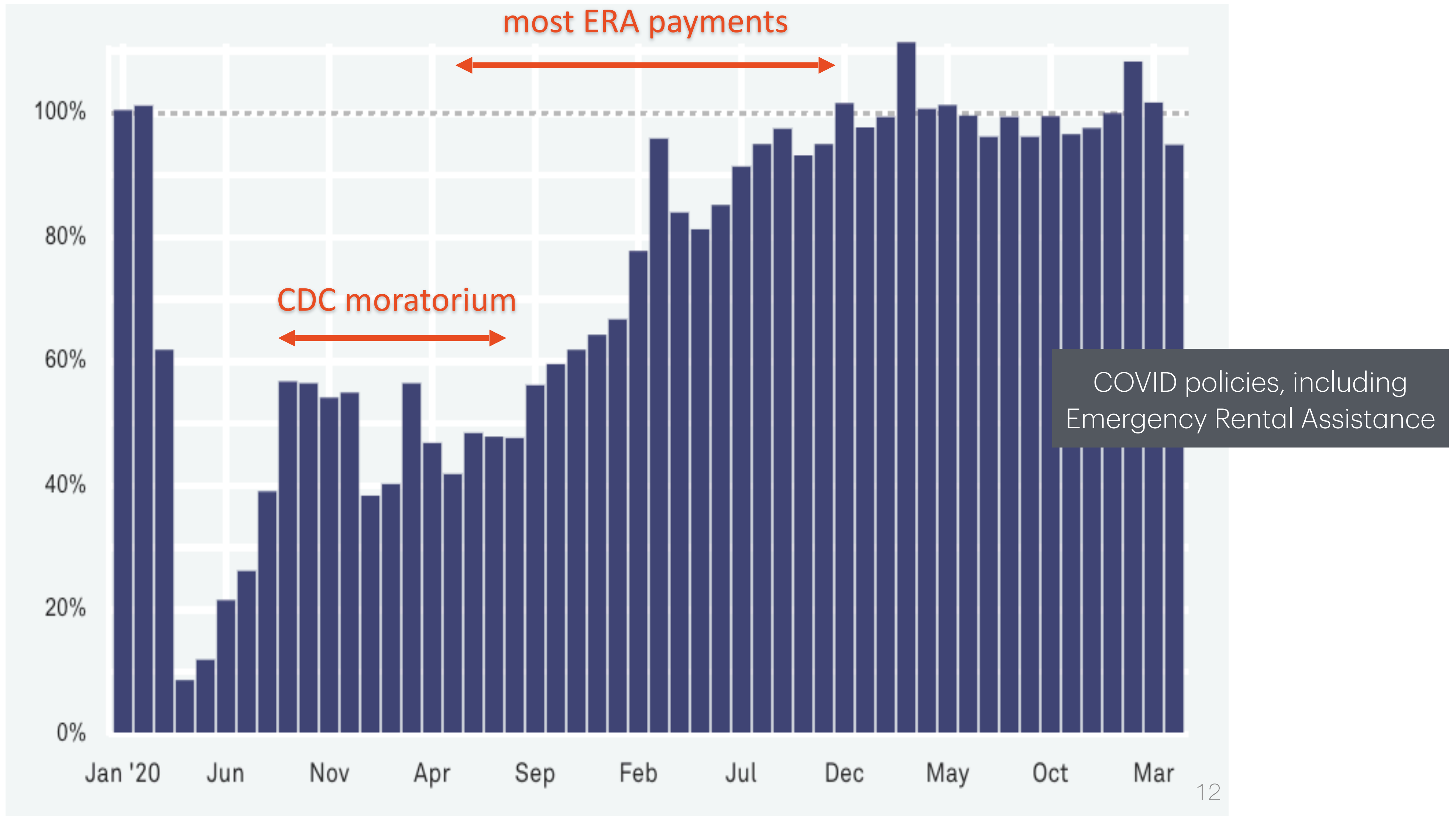
Percent change since 2001, adjusted for inflation



Source: CBPP tabulations of the Census Bureau's American Community Survey

Note: Dashed line indicates missing 2020 1-year ACS data due to pandemic-related data collection issues.

Eviction filings, 2020-2024



Key take-aways

- Millions of renters face eviction every year
 - 332,000 in a typical pre-pandemic year in New York
- Significant inequalities in risk
 - Where you live matters
 - Higher risk for Black renters, those with kids
 - Plausible violations of the Fair Housing Act
- These cases have serious consequences
 - Major health repercussions
 - Disruptive for kids
 - Long-term housing instability

Solutions

- Change laws and regulations
 - Increase eviction filing fees
 - Extend notice periods
 - Enact good cause eviction statutes
 - Seal court records
- Implement new programs
 - Right to counsel
 - Eviction diversion
- Improve existing programs
 - Enforce the FHA
 - SOI protections for voucher holders
- Build more affordable housing!

Thank You

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The Eviction Lab is funded by the
JPB, Gates, and Ford Foundations, c3.ai,
and the Chan Zuckerberg Initiative

The trope of the ghetto

- The term “**ghetto**” comes from 16th century Venice, where Jews were confined by law to a specific district
- Across medieval and early modern Europe, Jewish ghettos became common, often legally prescribed, walled, and locked at night. Notorious starved and imprisoned ghettos in the Third Reich (e.g., Warsaw ghetto incarcerated 400,000)
- In the 19th to early 20th century, with mass immigration to the U.S., the term became applied to ethnic enclaves for immigrant groups
- Only in the midst of the Great Migration did the term begin to apply to largely Black “inner city” neighborhoods — sometimes anchored by public housing, often walled off by highway construction, calcified by formal policy (loans), unequal service provision, and informal practice (real estate)



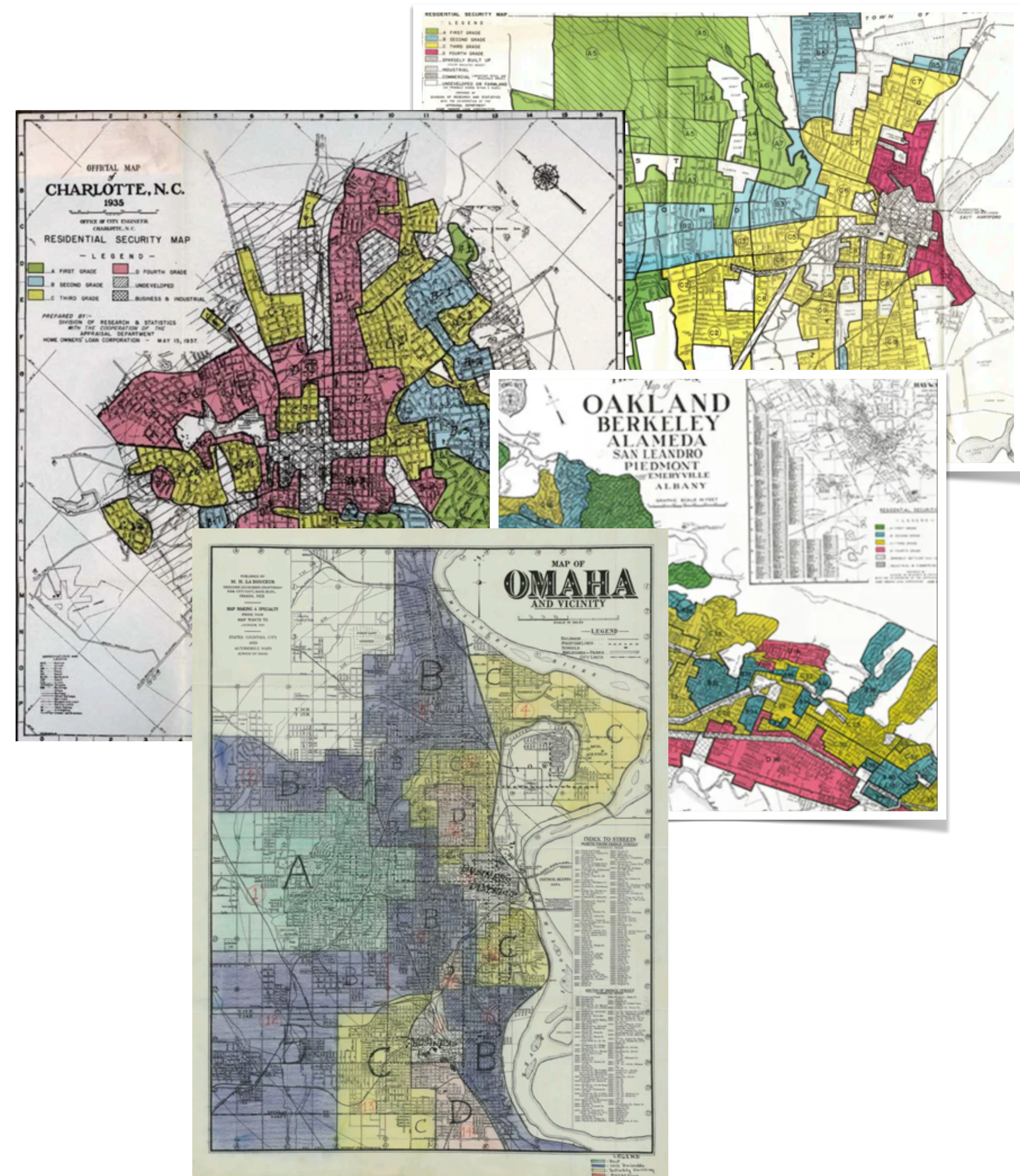
Warsaw 1942



Camden 2015

Redlining

- Home lenders produced literally color-coded maps starting in 1930s with FDR's HOLC (Home Owners Loan Corporation)
- Neighborhoods were graded for investment risk, with red or "hazardous" areas being marked for denial of mortgage loans and refinancing
- Policies were overtly racial, targeting Black neighborhoods
- HOLC refused to **make** loans, FHA refused to **insure** them
- Officially outlawed 1968, further addressed in Community Reinvestment Act of 1977



The trope of the suburb

site of fantasy (and horror)

- In most of the world, the rings around cities are slums
- Jackson writes of the “great inversion” — periphery becomes the prestige location
- suburban imaginary: pioneers self-making on the edge of settlement, cult of domesticity centering wife/mother that separates home from work, private family as unit of moral life, a spatial formation underwriting a mass-consumer citizenry
- homogeneity produced by formal policy and by informal practice
- interesting note: it’s not visible in Census variables! they use binary urban vs rural designation on geographies



FOR RELEASE MAY 22, 2018

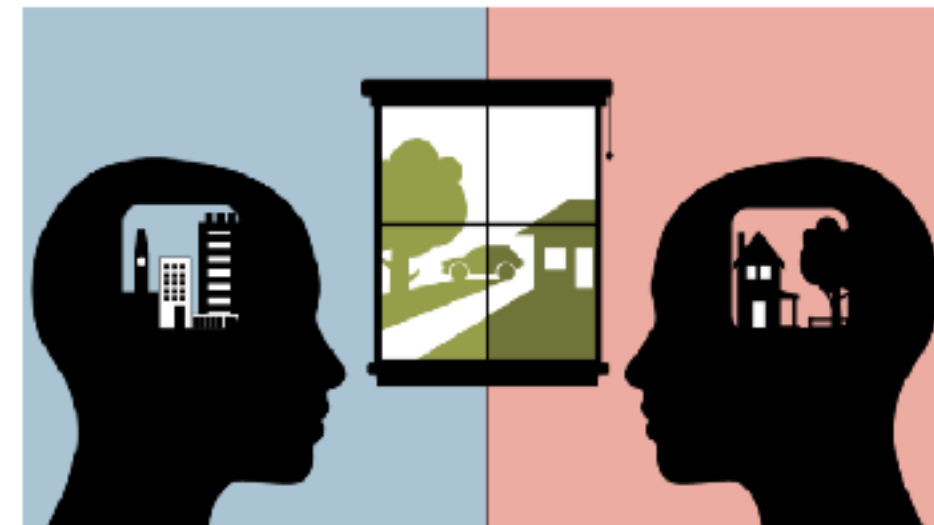
What Unites and Divides Urban, Suburban and Rural Communities

Amid widening gaps in politics and demographics, Americans in urban, suburban and rural areas share many aspects of community life

BY Kim Parker, Juliana Horowitz, Anna Brown, Richard Fry, D'Vera Cohn and Ruth Igielnik

Urban, suburban or rural? Americans' perceptions of their own community type differ by party

BY BRADLEY JONES



(Related posts: [Evaluating what makes a U.S. community urban, suburban or rural](#) and [Measuring community type in Europe, from big cities to country villages](#))

Partisanship in the United States has become increasingly [associated with geography](#). Over the past two decades, people living in urban areas have become more likely to identify as Democrats or lean toward the Democratic Party, while larger shares of those living in rural areas identify as

DEMOGRAPHIC RESEARCH | NOVEMBER 22, 2019

Evaluating what makes a U.S. community urban, suburban or rural

BY RUTH IGIELNIK, ELIZABETH GRIECO AND ALEXANDRA CASTILLO

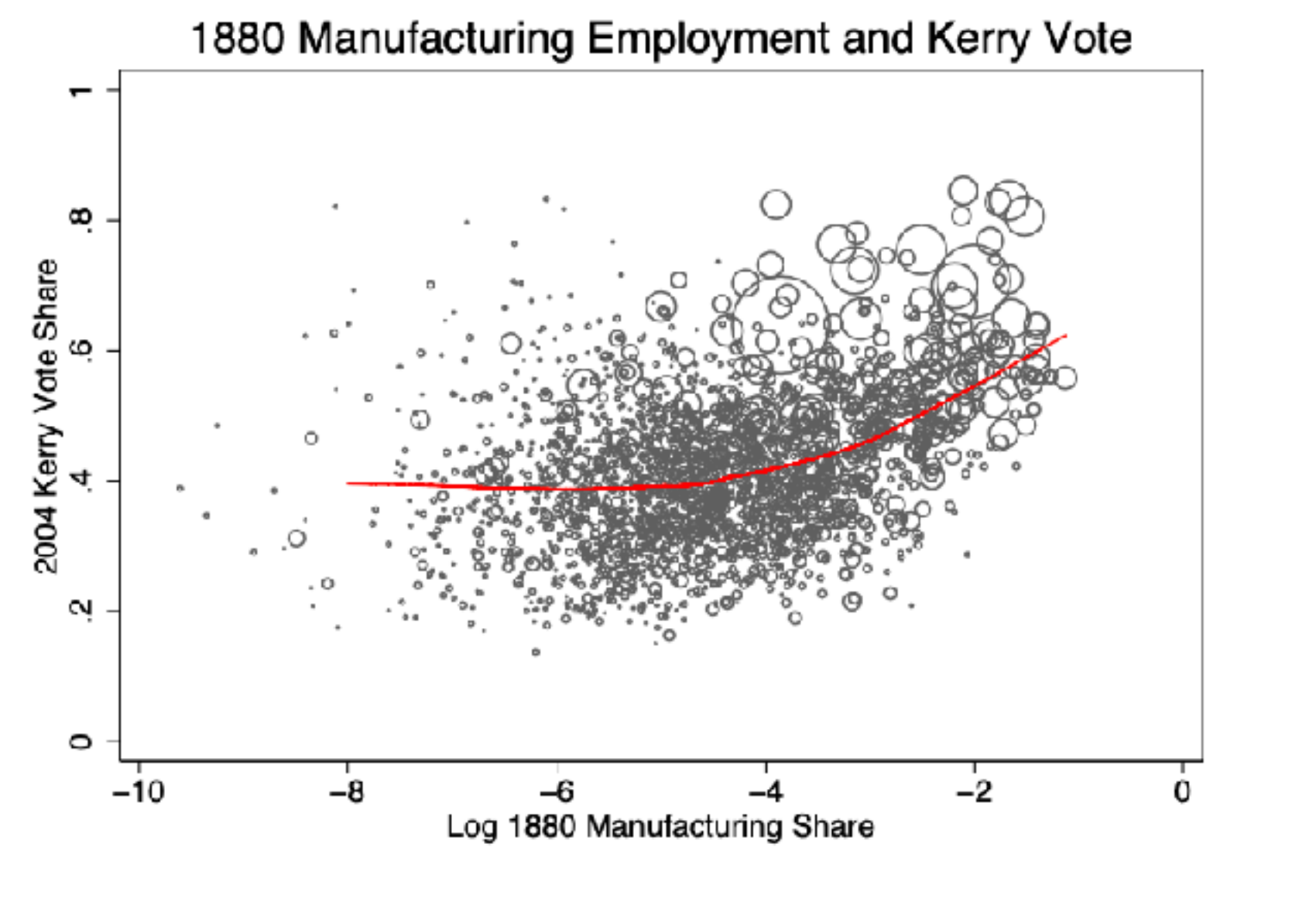
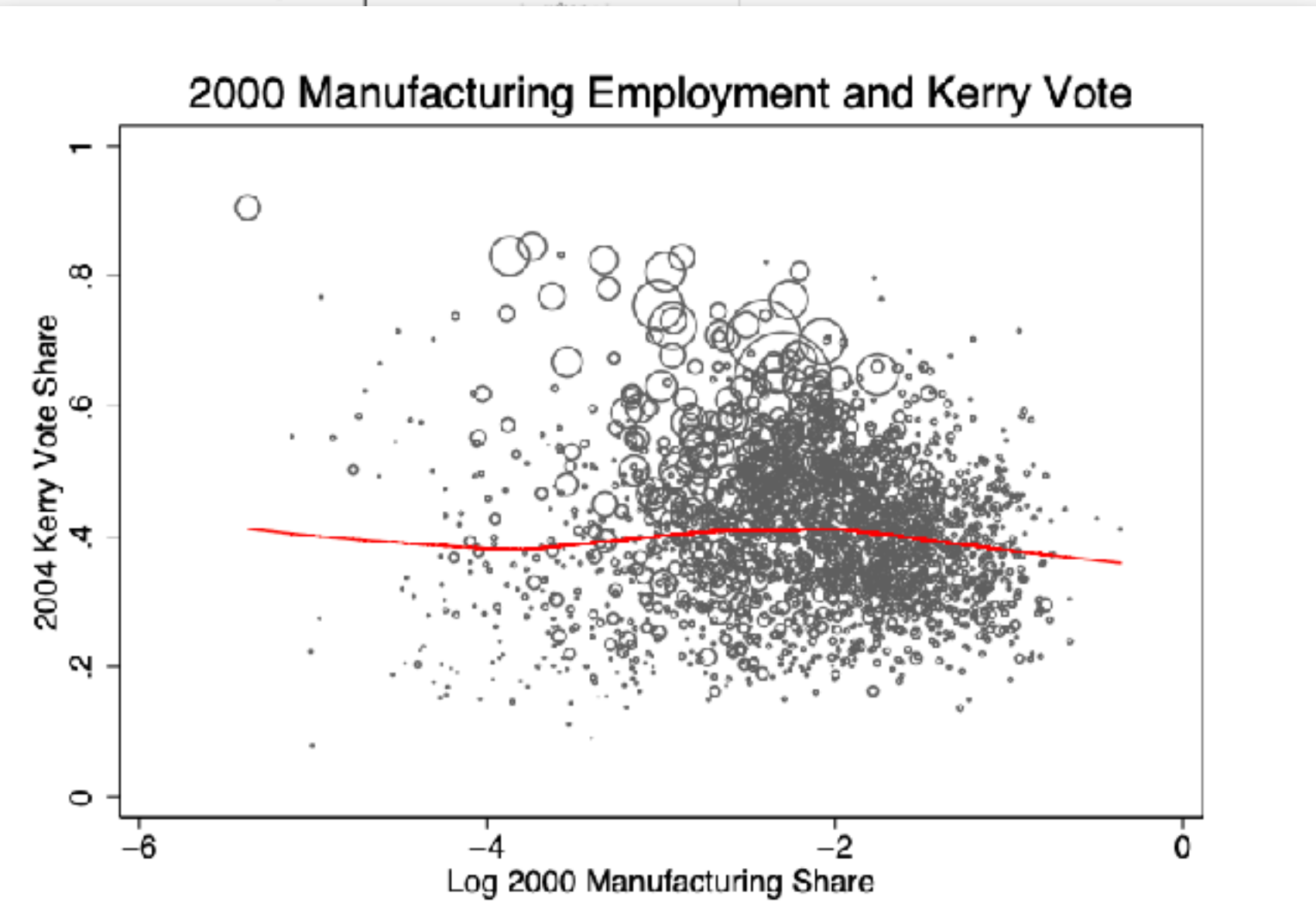
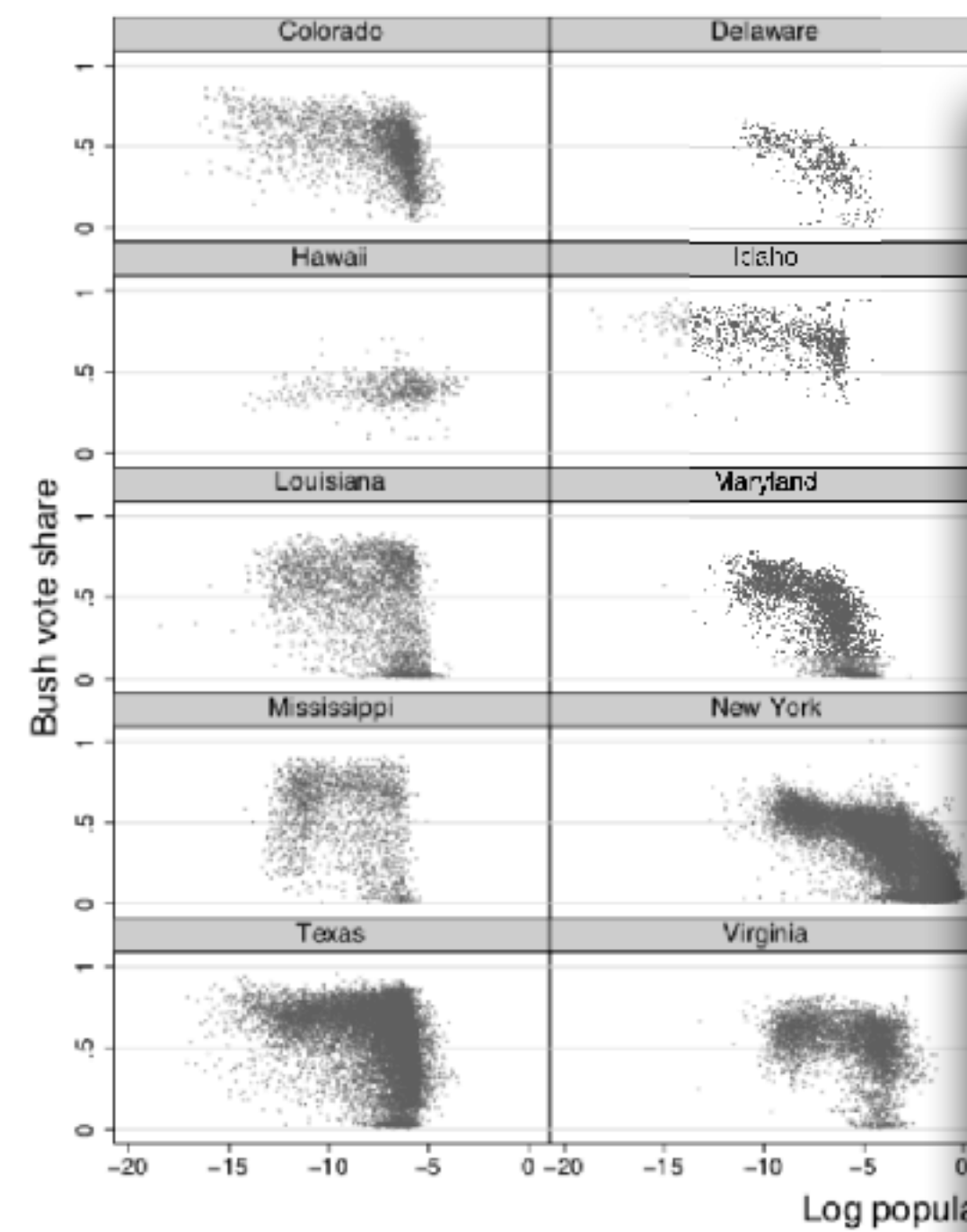
Urban, suburban and rural communities



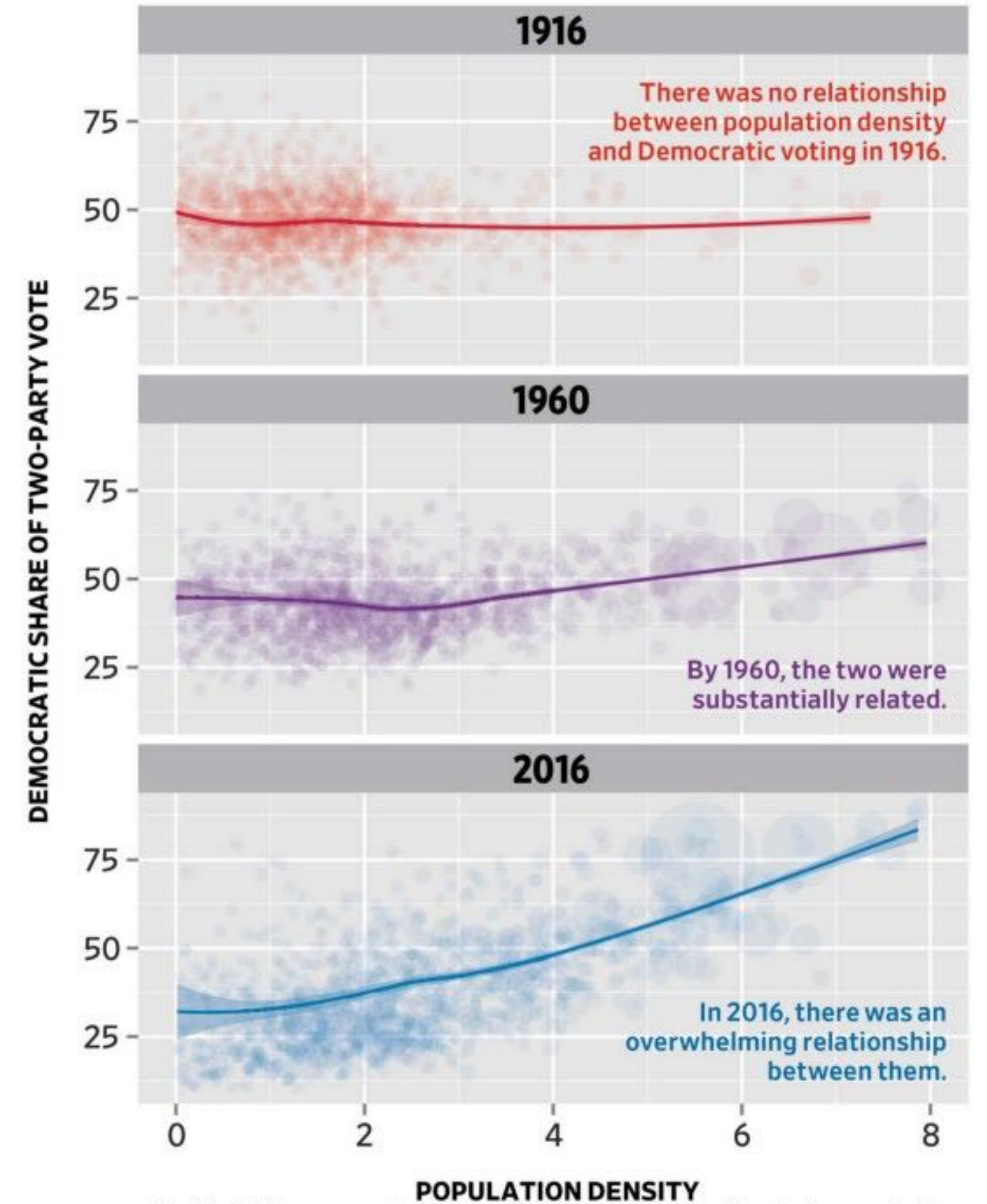
But what about the edge cases?



PEW RESEARCH CENTER



AT THE COUNTY LEVEL, A RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN POPULATION DENSITY AND DEMOCRATIC VOTING EMERGES



There was no relationship between population density and Democratic voting in 1916.

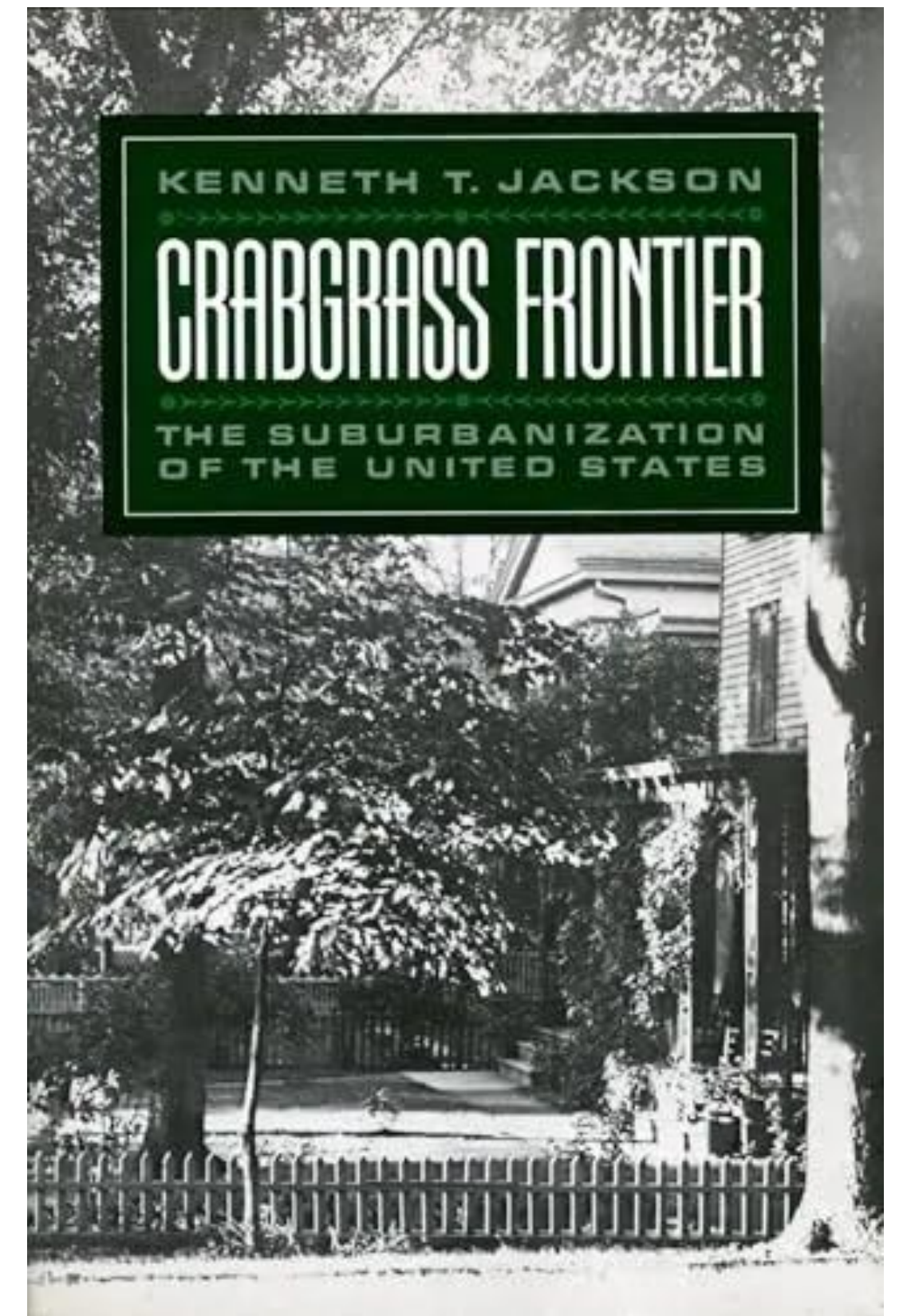
By 1960, the two were substantially related.

In 2016, there was an overwhelming relationship between them.

Each bubble represents a county and is sized according to its population. Population density has been logged.

Jackson

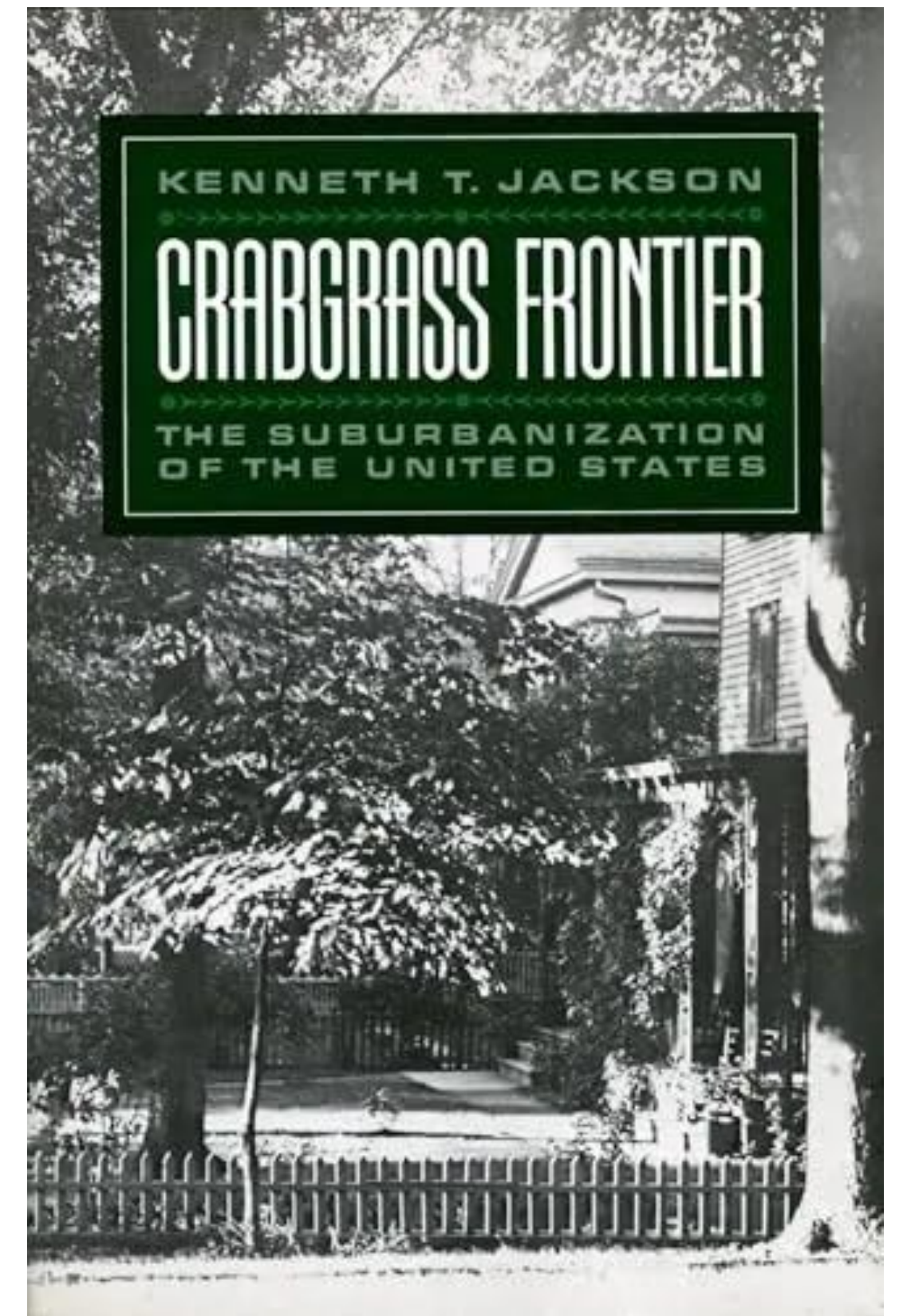
- Kenneth Jackson is an urban historian, retired from Columbia
- “Americans live in suburban areas that are far from their work places, in homes that they own, and in the center of yards that by urban standards elsewhere are enormous. This uniqueness thus involves population density, home-ownership, residential status, and journey-to-work.”
- “The first distinguishing element of metropolitan areas in this nation is their **low residential density** and the **absence of sharp divisions between town and country**. In all cultures, the price of land falls with greater and greater distance from city centers. Thus, the amount of space devoted to a single dwelling will always logically be greater on the periphery than at the center. In international terms, however, the structure of American settlement is loose, the decline in density (the density curve) is gradual, and land-use planning is weak.”



1985

International comparison

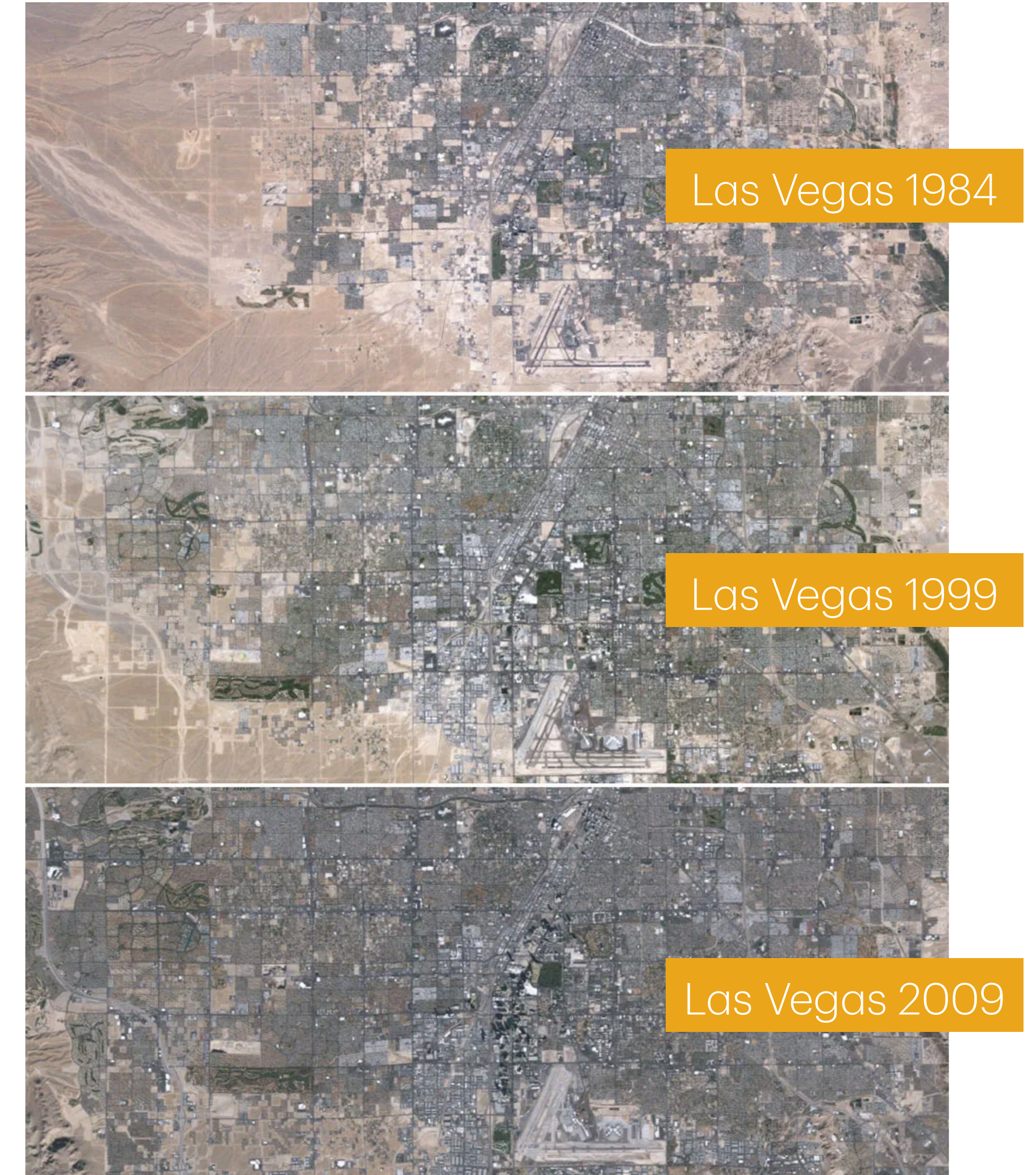
- Urbanization is global — UN Population Division says 1950 share of world pop in cities was **29%**. Up to **49%** by 2010, now a **majority**.
- But **form** varies: “More crowded urban conditions, sharply differentiated from the countryside, are more frequently found in other nations. The outer boundaries of Copenhagen, Moscow, Cologne, and Vienna abruptly terminate with apartment buildings, and a twenty-minute train ride will take one well into the countryside. Similarly, open fields surround the narrow streets and crowded houses of Siena and Florence. Metropolitan Tokyo has swallowed up tens of thousands of tiny farms since World War II, but private building plots rarely exceed one-twentieth of an acre. Unlike Western cities, Shanghai legally includes thousands of acres of productive farmland, but its population is concentrated at the center, where the average density reaches almost one hundred thousand people per square kilometer.”



1985

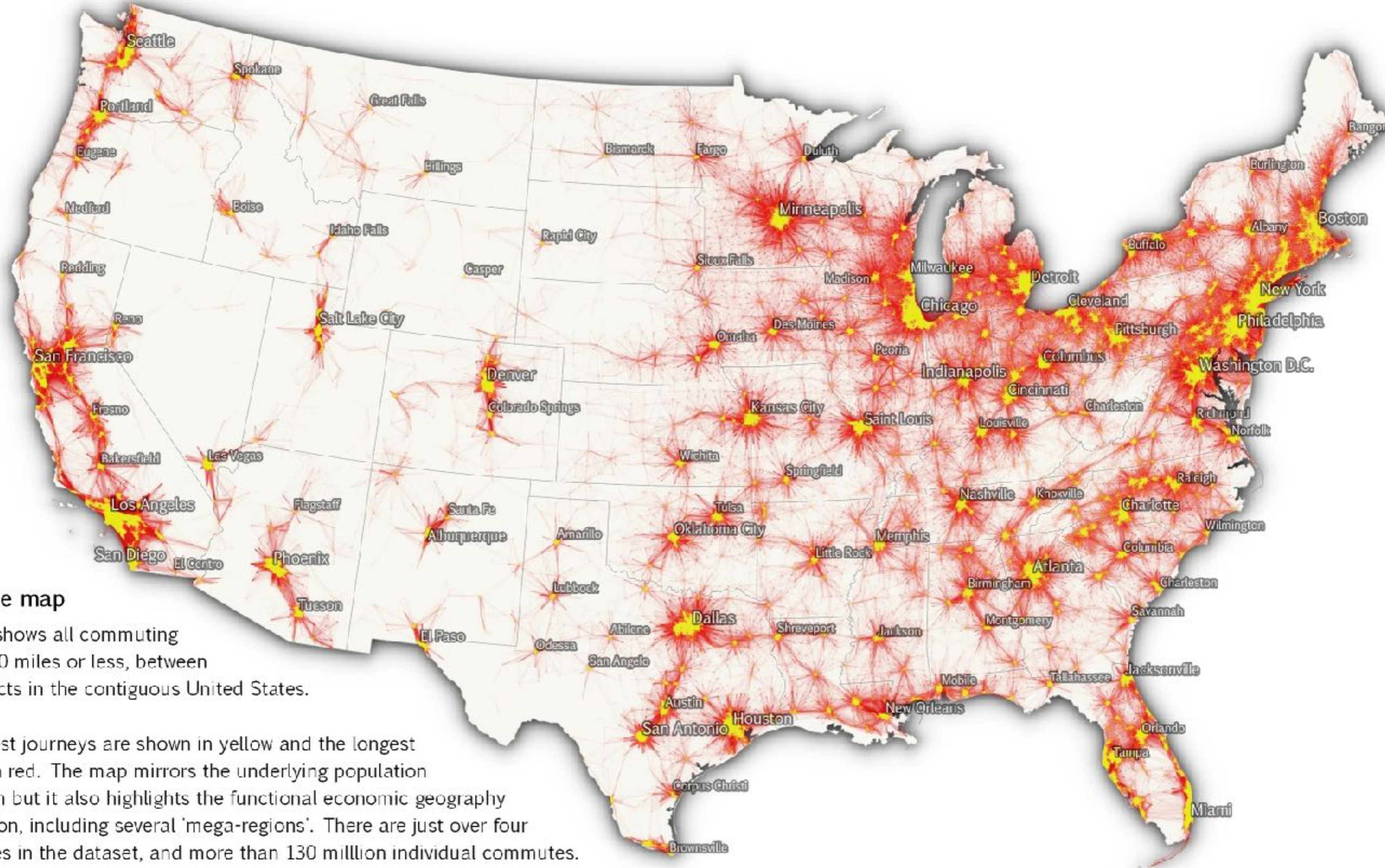
Urban sprawl

- “[T]he population of the metropolitan areas of Chicago, Illinois, Kansas City, Missouri, and Baltimore, Maryland, grew by 1 percent, 16 percent and 20 percent, respectively, between 1970 and 1990, but each area’s geographic extent grew by 24 percent, 55 percent, and 91 percent, respectively. The **spatial footprints** of major cities in the Midwest and the Northeast, such as Detroit, Michigan, and Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, grew approximately 30 percent even as the cities experienced declines in population over the same period.”
- Countermovement: “smart growth” / New Urbanism



The American Commute

A functional economic geography of the United States



About the map

This map shows all commuting links of 100 miles or less, between census tracts in the contiguous United States.

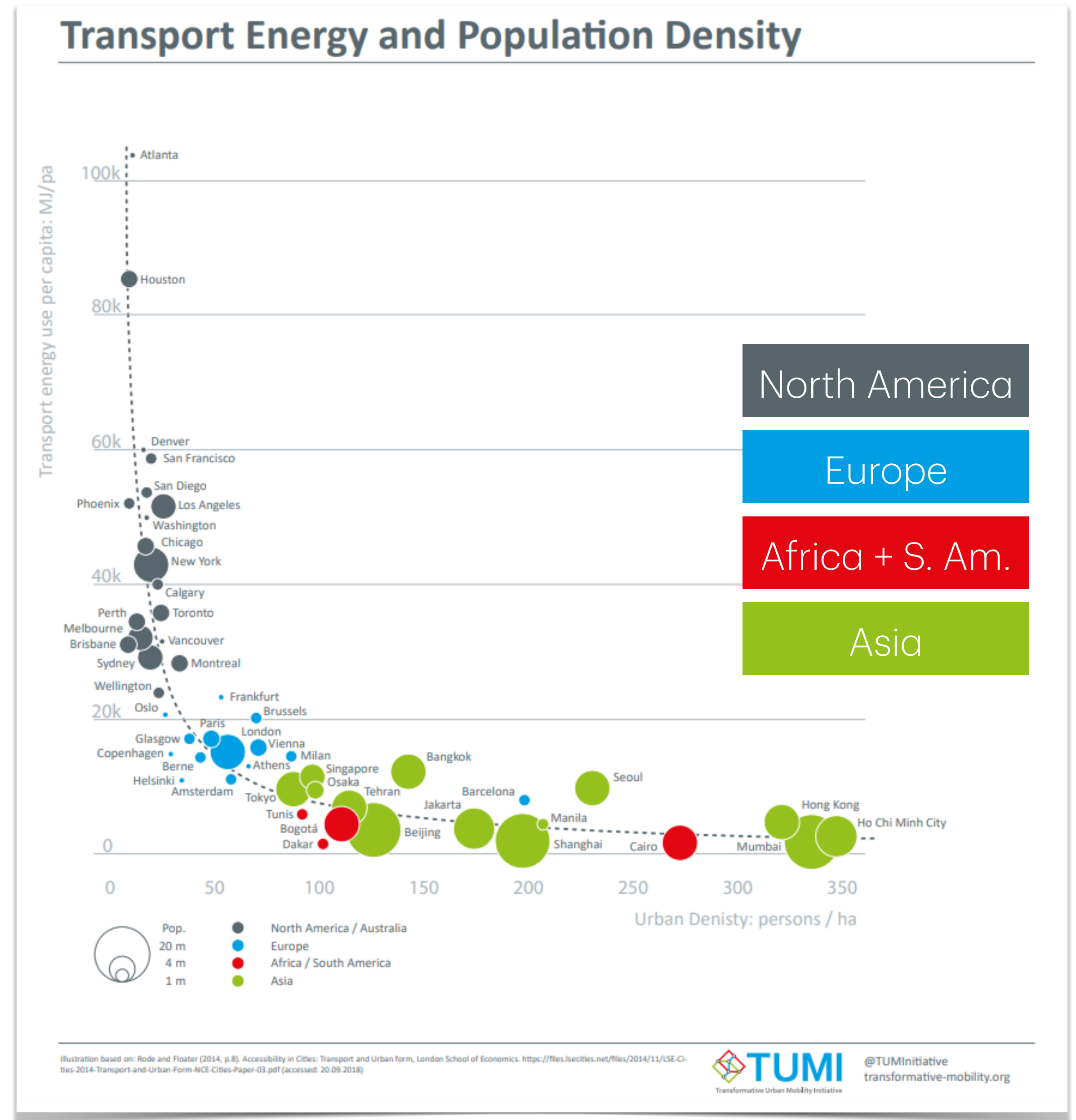
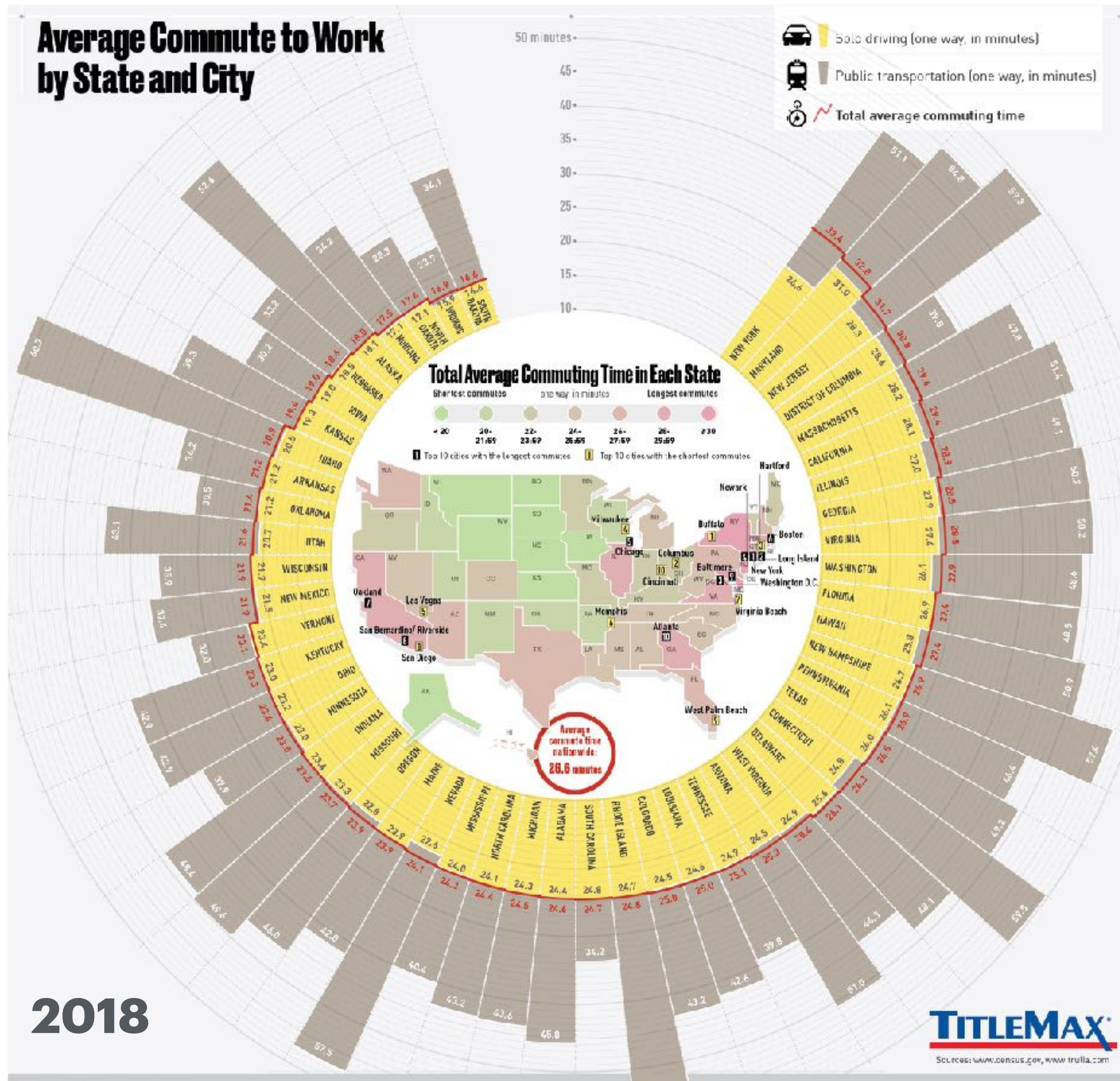
The shortest journeys are shown in yellow and the longest journeys in red. The map mirrors the underlying population distribution but it also highlights the functional economic geography of the nation, including several 'mega-regions'. There are just over four million lines in the dataset, and more than 130 million individual commutes.

Data Source: American Community Survey 2006-2010

500 miles

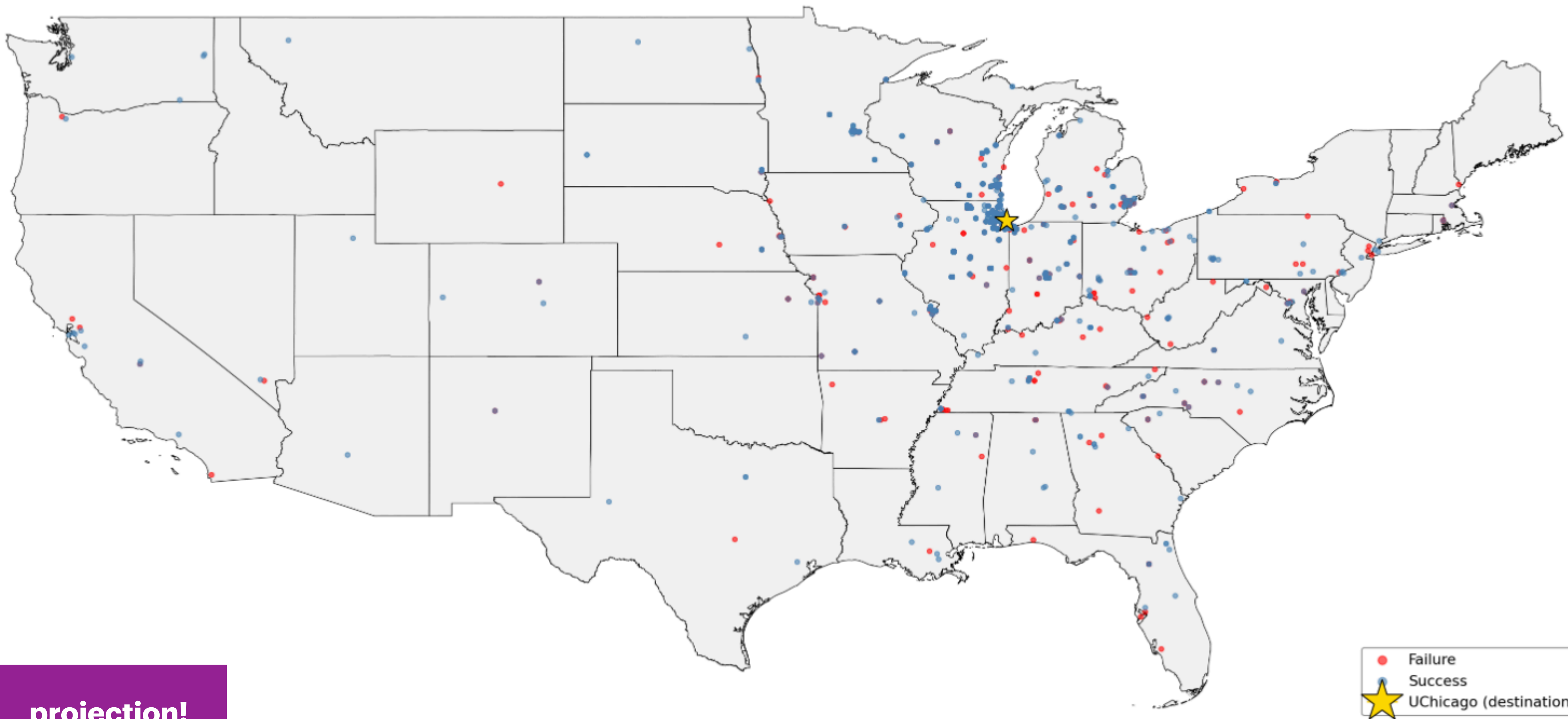
Map created by Alasdair Rae

source:
Alasdair
Rae



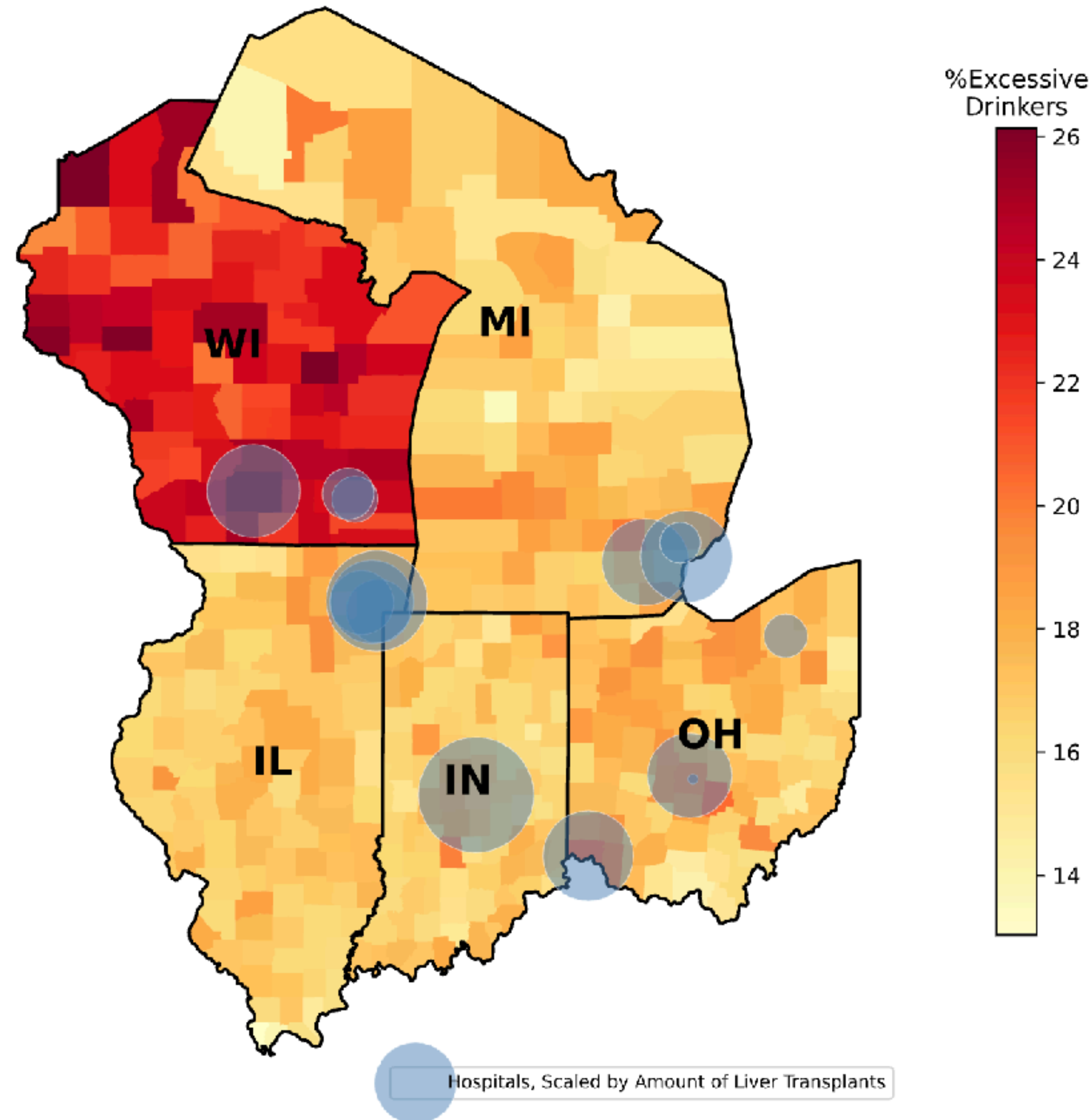
source: Transformative Urban Mobility Initiative

Liver Donor Origins for University of Chicago Transplants
(Blue = 1-year success, Red = failure)



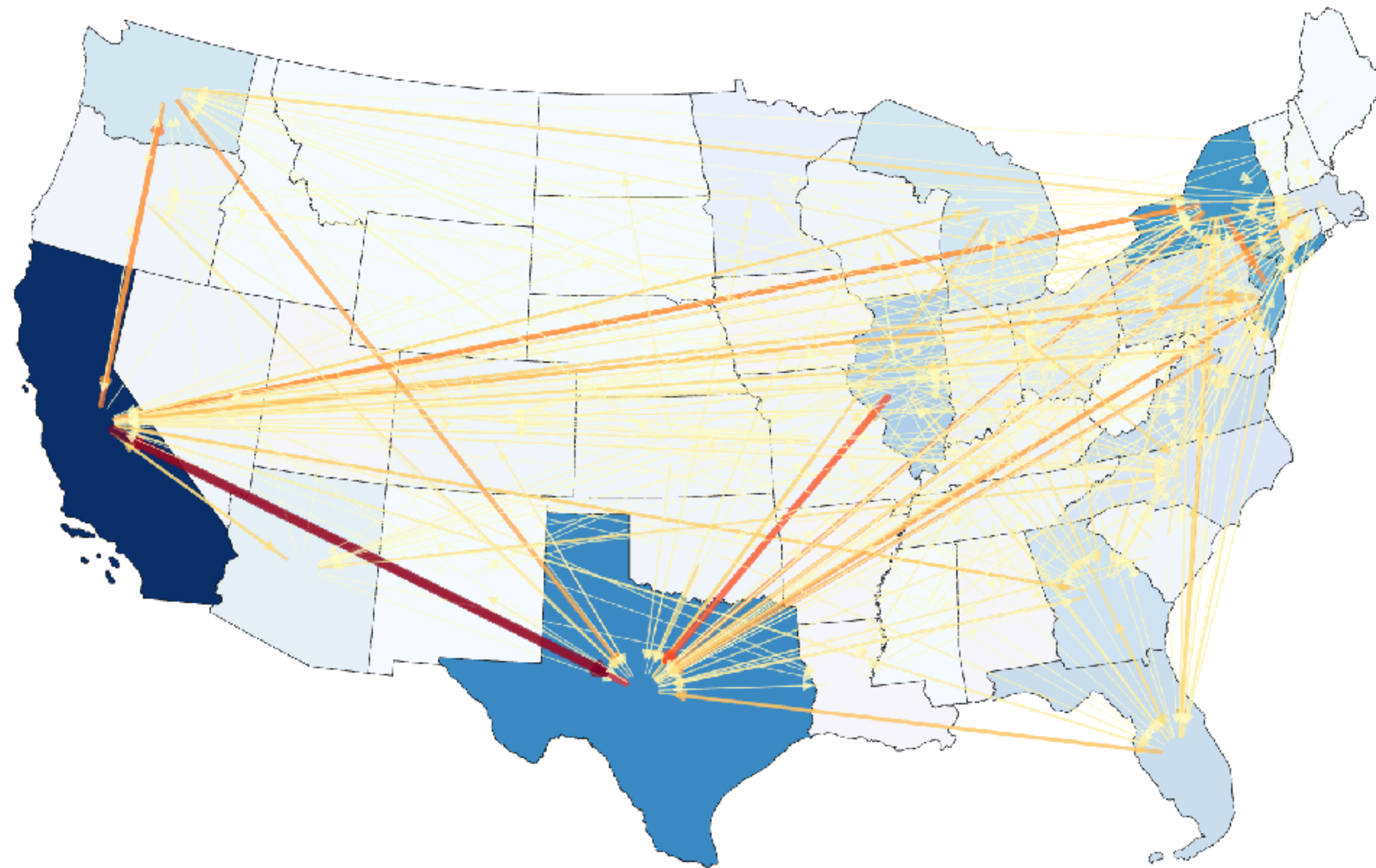
projection!

Excessive Drinking by County Relative to Liver Transplant Centers, East North Central Region

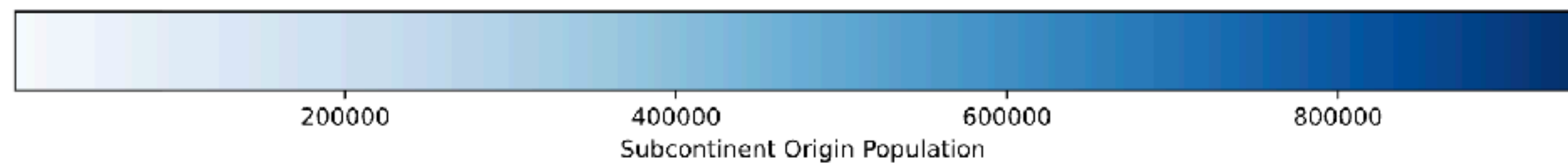


Source: CDC BRFSS, County Health Rankings & Roadmaps, <https://intoxistates.com/>

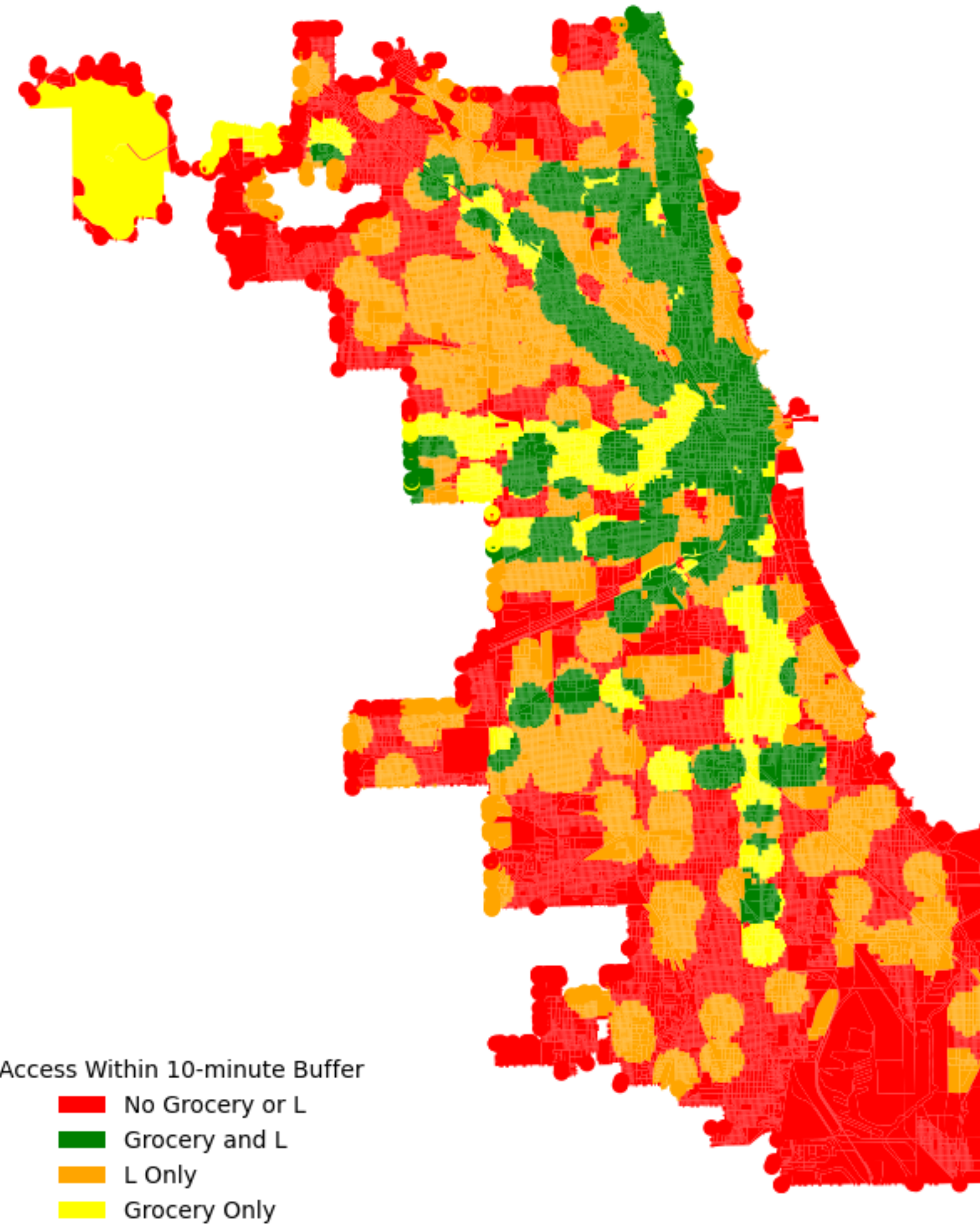
Subcontinent Origin Population (India/Pakistan/Bangladesh/Sikhs) - ACS 2023
Paired With PUMS Across States Flow Data
(Darker Arrows Denote a Larger Flow)



**normalization
and
thresholding**



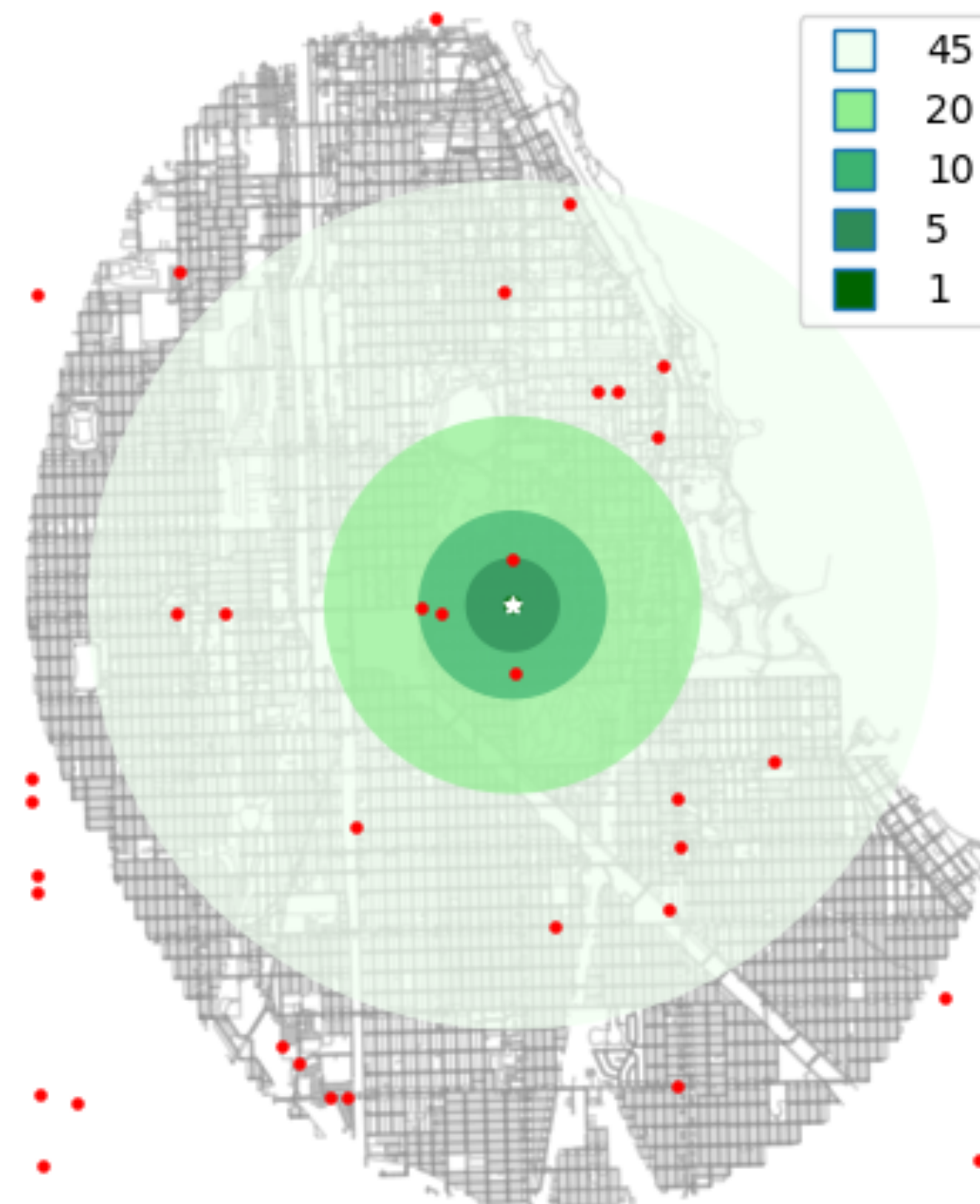
Transit And Grocery Access by Chicago Census Blocks



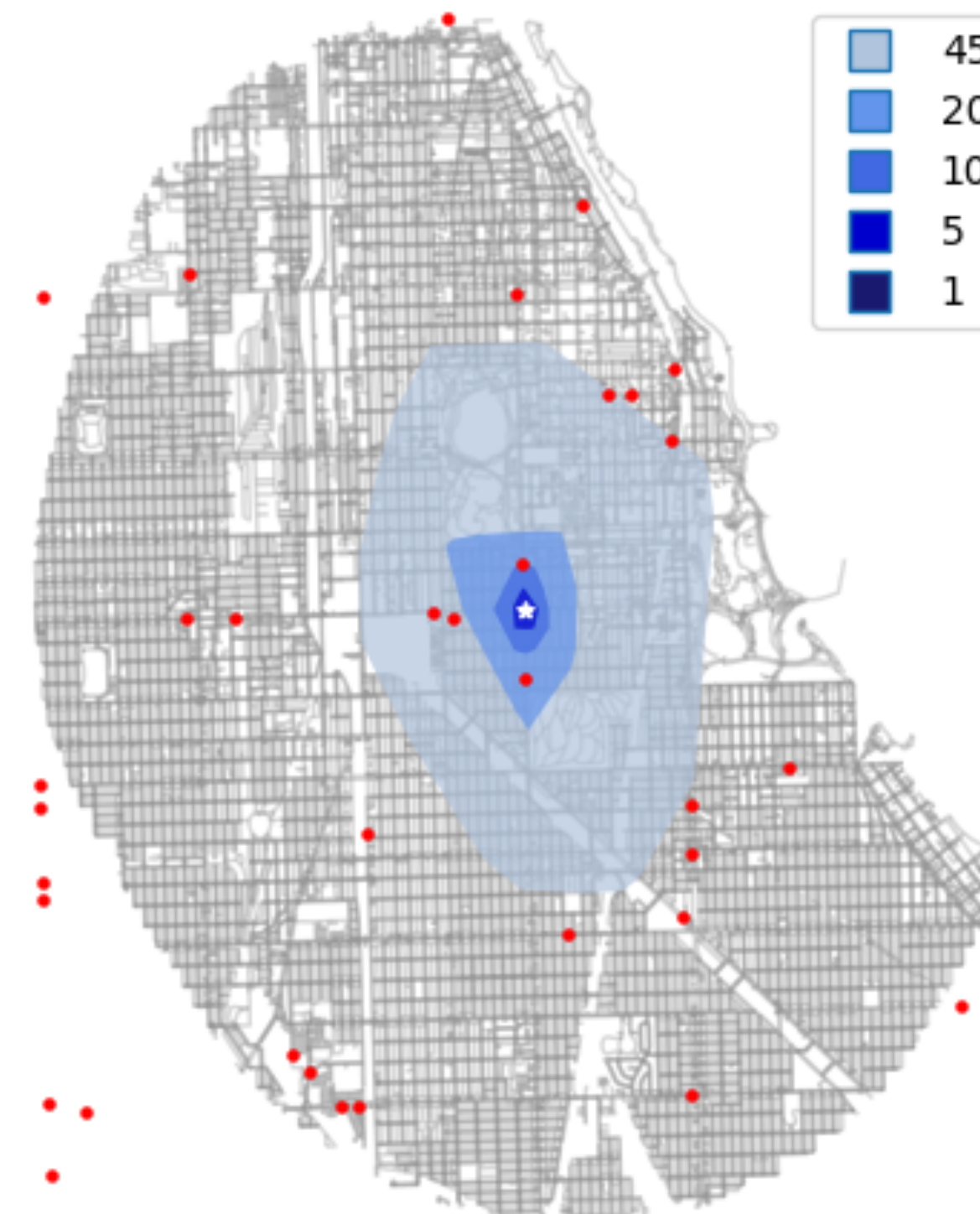
layering

Distance from the Cottage Grove L station to Woodlawn grocery stores

As the crow flies (minutes)



Network distance (minutes)



assumptions

Racial Group with Highest Net Outflow

- White
- Black or African American
- American Indian or Alaska Native
- Asian / Pacific Islander
- Some Other Race
- Two or More Races
- No dominant outflow

500 km

normalization

